lands. It is of utmost importance to increase the productivity of these lands.

Production in the rainfed areas can be substantially increased through appropriate soil and water management practices, including planned use of watersheds, water harvesting to provide for crop saving irrigation, soil moisture conservation and cropping system with limited use of fertiliser.

18. The Department of Agricultural Research and Education (DARE) was set up in 1973 in the Ministry of Agriculture. It is responsible for coordinating research and educational activities in agriculture, animal husbandry and fisheries. It also brings about collaboration among various departments and institutions engaged in the same or allied fields on national and international levels. It provides government support, service and linkage to the ICAR.

    The Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR) is a registered society, an autonomous body under DARE. It is the apex body responsible for promoting, conducting and coordinating research, education and primary extension education in agriculture, animal sciences, fisheries and allied sectors in India.

19. TheNationalAgriculturalTechnology Project (NATP), being implemented by the ICAR and Department of Agriculture and Cooperation has three major components, viz., research, organisation and management, and innovations in technology dissemination.

    Constraints in technology transfer may be technological, organisational and administrative, social, as well as some basic constraints. Specifically they relate to areas including marketing and pricing, soil and water resources conservation, evolving high-yielding and disease-resistant crop types, proper availability and use of chemicals such as weedicides, lack of transport and training facilities, and absence of proper study and in- depth evaluation.

20. Rice production has shown consistent rise over the years; quality too has improved. This is mainly due to the new high yielding varieties. The dwarf varieties are not only significantly superior to the tall indicas in responding to fertiliser, but they also give higher yield even under low doses of fertilisers.